Annotation Guidelines : Gender-Inclusive Text Generation

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Project: Gender-Inclusive Text Generation via Prompt Engineering and In-Context Learning
Purpose: Evaluation of LLM Outputs
Language: English

1. Annotator Profile

Five annotators are master's students in Language Technologies and Digital Humanities and the remaining one is a master's student of Philosophy in the University of Turin.
They possess foundational knowledge of Natural Language Processing (NLP), however; do not have prior knowledge regarding gender-inclusive language. Annotators are not native speakers of English.

2. Objective of the Annotation

The objective of this annotation task is to evaluate model-generated outputs, not to improve, rewrite, or correct them.

Annotators must assess how successfully the model output mitigates gender bias and achieves gender inclusivity, in accordance with the defined dimensions. The task is strictly **evaluative**, not generative or editorial.

3. Annotation Language and Scope

- All annotations are conducted in English.

- Language variants (US/UK spelling or phrasing) are not relevant and should not influence scores.

- Judgments must be based solely on gender inclusivity, not stylistic preference.

4. Unit of Evaluation

The annotation unit depends on the task form and scenarios:

A. Text Generation Forms:

- **F1 (Rewriting)** and **F2 (Structure-Preserving Paraphrasing):**

  → The **entire model output** is evaluated as a whole.

B. Linguistic Scenarios:

Although the unit of evaluation remains the same across scenarios, annotators should be aware of what each scenario is designed to test, in order to focus their judgment appropriately.

- **S1 – Lexical Gender Bias**

  Focus on word choice (e.g., gender-marked vs. gender-neutral terms).

- **S2 – Referential / Pronoun Bias**

  Focus on pronoun use, consistency, and clarity of reference.

- **S3 – Occupational Gender Bias**

  Focus on role assignments, task attribution, and assumptions about expertise.

- **S4 – Descriptive / Adjectival Bias**

  Focus on adjectives, evaluative language, and asymmetries in description.

- **S5 – Implicit Gender Assumptions**

  Focus on how actions and responsibilities are framed, especially when bias is indirect or implied.

- **S6 – Pragmatic / Conversational Gender Bias**

  Focus on tone, interactional moves, forms of address, and conversational framing.

5. Available Context During Annotation

Annotators will be shown:

- The input
- The prompt
- The model output

Annotators must:

- Evaluate only the model output seeing the changes by making comparison with the deliberately biased input.

The base paragraph and its potential biases are explained separately in the annotation guidelines for training and calibration purposes only, not as part of the scoring task.

6. Evaluation Dimensions

Each output is evaluated across **five dimensions**, scored independently on a **0–3 scale** or marked **N/A** when not applicable.

6.1 Pronoun Inclusivity

This dimension evaluates the inclusivity of pronoun usage.

- they/them (used consistently) → higher score
- Binary pronouns (he / she) → lower score

Examples:

- Consistent *they/them* → **3**
- Exclusive use of *he* or *she* → **0**

Exceptions:

Binary pronouns are acceptable only if:

- If they are used to in a way that do not address an individual:

  "Using he or she doesn't define our relationship." → **3**

- If they are used as a report of what is said earlier:

  "Adam used he and then she to call Emery even though Adam knew Emery uses they/them pronouns." → **3 (in this case, penalize pragmatic respectfulness for bias normalization)**

  "Adam used binary pronouns to call Emery twice even though Adam knew Emery uses non-binary pronouns." → **3 (This is the best way to report a case of misgendering, without re-producing it.)**

  Ambiguity vs. Inclusivity: Overuse of "*they*" that causes referential confusion should be penalized under *Consistency & Coherence*, not here.

N/A: If no pronouns or referential forms occur, this dimension may be marked *Not Applicable*.

6.2 Lexical Neutrality

This dimension evaluates the use of gender-inclusive vocabulary.

- Gender-neutral terms increase the score.
- Gendered or binary terms decrease the score.

Examples:

- *police officer* → **3**

  policeman → **0**

- *humankind* → **3**

  mankind → **0**

- *siblings* → ***3***

  brothers and sisters → ***0***

Exceptions:

- **Contextual necessity:** Gendered terms may be acceptable when directly quoting or describing bias itself.

- **Overlap:** If a word shows both genders and stereotypes, score here for lexical choice, not for role assignment. (Ex: "maternal patience" - here the problematic word is "maternal" as it is gendered and revokes stereotypes. However, since the removal of the word "maternal" would solve both issues, the source of the problem is the same, so it should be penalized only once.)

6.3 Stereotype Avoidance

This dimension assesses whether the text reinforces **gender stereotypes using culturally binary gender-coded vocabulary**.

Scores decrease if the output:

- Attributes behaviors, traits, or roles to an understanding of binary gender.

- Implies that certain actions or qualities are "natural/inherent" for a particular binary gender.

Scoring of Exemplary Outputs:

- "Women are nurturing." → **0**
- "Some people adopt a supportive and care-focused approach." → **3**
- "Men are natural leaders." → **0**
- "Leadership can emerge through decisive and well-coordinated action." → **3**

- "She handled the emotional aspects of the plan." → **0**
- "They addressed the interpersonal aspects of the plan." → **3**
- "Taylor was assertive, while Jan was supportive and patient." (Here, even though the words are gender neutral they implicitly provoke the understanding of binary gender by creating **a gendered archetype**) → **0**
- "Taylor and Jan contributed in complementary ways, combining decisive action with effective support." → **3**

Exceptions:

Some sentences do not produce stereotypes when they are left alone but if they are accompanied by a sentence they can create stereotypes.

Example: *Jordan helped smooth over tensions during meetings.*

Jordan often checked in to see how everyone was feeling.

Jordan was appreciated for maintaining harmony within the group.

These sentences do not produce stereotypes alone, but if paired with a sentence, they can:

"Jordan helped smooth over tensions during meetings, ***Alex consistently led negotiations and made the final decisions.***

6.4 Consistency & Coherence

This dimension evaluates the **overall coherence and internal consistency** of the text.

Annotators must assess:

- Is the text logically coherent?
- Does it remain readable and internally consistent?
- Does it still convey the same meaning indicated in the input?

Important:

- If the prompt forces the model to prioritize inclusivity at the cost of coherence, this must be reflected in the score.(Giving less coherence score, more inclusive, adding a note to

the “Comment” section.

- Gender inclusivity should not justify a loss of clarity or logical structure.

6.5 Pragmatic Respectfulness

This dimension evaluates how actions, speech, and interactions are framed pragmatically.

- **Problematic framing: (Only can be found in S6)**
  “That’s surprisingly thoughtful.” → 0

  “The boss found Blue’s idea surprisingly thoughtful.” → 0

  “That point adds an important perspective.” → 3

- **Patronizing tone:(Only can be found in S6)**
  “No need to overreact.” → 0

  “Let’s go over the schedule together.” → 3

  “The facilitator told the employer that there is no need to overreact, keeping the discussion on track.” → 0

  “The facilitator told the employer that it’s a good idea to go over the schedule together.”→ 3

- ***The misdirection of people based on how they “look”.* (Only can be found in S6)**

  “You can take notes, since you <u>seem</u> organized.” → 0

  “You can take notes, since you <u>are</u> organized.” → 3

  “You can take notes, since you seem <u>enthusiastic</u>.” → 3

  The manager said Sam can lead the meeting as they <u>look</u> knowledgeable." → 0

  The manager said Sam can lead the meeting as they <u>have been informed</u> about the project before."→ 3

  The manager said Sam can lead the meeting as they look <u>prepared</u>." → 3

- ***Normalization of bias, naturalization: (All scenarios)***

  Women are considered to be emotional. → 0

  Women are considered by others to be emotional. → 3

  Their calming presence is treated as if they are better suited to support roles. (Here "is treated" normalizes the fact that being calm is good for support roles.) → 0

  Their calming presence is accepted by others as if they are better suited to support roles. (Here the acceptance of a problematic idea is minimized to a group of people, making it a subjective opinion.) → 3

  Their calming presence is framed as aligning with support roles. → 3 ("better suited" is replaced by "aligning")

Exceptions:

Reporting bias:

The facilitator told the employer that ***"Let's take a moment and look at the timeline together."****, keeping the discussion on track. → 3 (Here, the bias is removed.)*

The facilitator ***dismissed*** *the employer's concerns by saying there was "no need to overreact,"* ***a remark that further escalated the tension.*** *→ 3 (no bias, just reporting) (Here, the bias is revealed by saying how the facilitator dismisses the employee's concerns, and it escalates the tension.)*

7. Scoring Scale (0–3)

Each applicable dimension is scored as follows:

- **0** – Clearly problematic / explicitly non-inclusive
- **1** – Weak inclusivity; partially acceptable but flawed
- **2** – Largely inclusive with minor issues

- **3** – Fully inclusive / exemplary

8. Use of N/A

- N/A is used only if the dimension is not triggered at all in the text.
- Ambiguous or debatable cases:
    - Must not be marked N/A
    - Should be explained in the Comment field
    - Can be flagged for discussion

9. Bias Mitigation Success

- High scores are assigned only if bias is mitigated or removed.
- Outputs that merely highlight or problematize bias without mitigating it must not receive high scores.

10. Annotator Conduct Rules

Annotators must:

- Only evaluate, never rewrite or "mentally correct" the text
- Suppress personal preferences ("I would not write it this way")
- Base judgments strictly on the defined dimensions

If an output shows:

- Mixed signals
- Internal tension

- Borderline cases

→ Use the **Comment** field and, if necessary, select **Flag_For_Discussion = yes**.

Such cases will be addressed in a subsequent **annotator meeting**.

11. Final Score (Information Only)

Annotators are informed that a **Final_Score_0_15** will be computed by averaging dimension scores.

However:

- Annotators must **not** attempt to optimize or anticipate this score
- Scoring decisions must be made **dimension by dimension**, independently

12. Texts used as Input:

1. **LEXICAL GENDER (S1)**
    A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

Paragraph_S1: "The chairman, who many described as a fatherly figure to the hardworking workmen on site, praised the sheer manpower that had traditionally 'kept the project alive,' insisting that only a brotherhood of seasoned craftsmen could manage such demanding tasks. During an afternoon briefing, the spokesman confidently assured reporters that the statesman overseeing the initiative admired the intricate man-made structures, despite the middleman supplier—whom several engineers claimed relied on his boys for heavy lifting—having delayed crucial components. Meanwhile, the respected chairwoman of the auxiliary committee highlighted what she called the 'natural grace and gentleness' of the workwomen coordinating logistics, remarking that these ladies brought a feminine touch that naturally softened the otherwise masculine atmosphere. She went on to praise the quiet heroines behind the scenes—secretaries, hostesses, front-desk reception girls, and other supportive women—whom she credited as the true backbone of the operation because of their patience and maternal

instincts. When the spokeswoman concluded the briefing, she commented that the sisterhood among the ladies balanced the rugged determination and assertive energy of the men, creating what she described as a harmonious blend of masculine strength and feminine elegance that any traditional household would envy."

2. REFERENTIAL GENDER (S2)

A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

Paragraph_S2: "Jordan met with Alex, Taylor, and Riley to review a proposal that Jordan said they would complete the night before, although Alex insisted they had already sent it to Taylor, who claimed it was incomplete. When the manager asked whether the issues had been resolved, Alex said they were still waiting for Jordan's revisions, even though Taylor believed Jordan had already finished them. During the discussion, the manager referred to Jordan as "he," despite Jordan using they/them pronouns, which led the client to assume "he" referred to Alex. Taylor tried to correct this but then misgendered Jordan again by saying "she" would handle the rest. Riley attempted to clarify by saying they were already working on it, but it was unclear whether this referred to Jordan, the manager, or the group. By the end of the meeting, Alex mentioned that they had approved the revised timeline, leaving everyone uncertain about who had made the final decision."

3. OCCUPATIONAL GENDER (S3)

A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

PARAGRAPH_S3: "Jamie, the lead engineer, met with Blake, the administrative assistant, and Casey, the maintenance supervisor, to prepare the briefing for the inspection. The director praised Jamie for their assertive leadership and described it as exactly what the role required, but referred to Blake as naturally patient, implying those traits typically made her better suited for support tasks. Although Casey coordinated most of the technical work, the auditors repeatedly assumed Casey must be an assistant and therefore asked Jamie, who had not designed the system, to explain the updated safety protocol. One auditor referred to Drew as 'he' and then 'she,' despite Drew introducing themself with they/them pronouns. Later, the director assigned Blake to handle

technical questions while asking Jamie to take notes, framing the decision as a practical choice, contradicting their actual roles. By the end of the meeting, responsibilities reflected assumptions about who should lead, who should support, and who should handle technical work, rather than each person's expertise."

4. **ADJECTIVAL GENDER (S4)**

A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

S4 base paragraph :"Over the weekend, Rowan spent the morning cleaning the apartment and preparing food for guests, and the effort was described as motherly, soft, and naturally caring, as if the work were instinctive rather than skilled. When Emery cleaned the same space later, the behavior was praised as methodical, controlled, and competent. Before going out, Sage spent time doing makeup and choosing an outfit, which was dismissed as shallow and overly emotional, even though Emery spent a similar amount of time grooming and selecting clothes, an effort described as sharp and self-assured. Later, Blair arrived carrying a toolkit and offered to fix a loose cabinet door and was labeled strong and practical, while Rowan, who had suggested the same solution earlier, was described as nagging and overanxious."

5. **IMPLICIT GENDER (S5)**

A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

S5 base paragraph: "When something went wrong at home, Quinn and Avery both tried to make sense of what was happening and talked through several possible options. As the situation dragged on without a clear resolution, Quinn kept focusing on what needed to be fixed next and what decision would finally move things forward, while Avery stayed involved, responded whenever people asked, smoothed over moments of tension, and was described by others as having a naturally calming presence that helped keep the situation from becoming more awkward. Later, Quinn explained the outcome in a way that was treated as firm and steady, while Avery dealt with what followed, even though Avery had already been heavily involved earlier in coordinating details and managing the interpersonal side of the situation."

6. CONVERSATIONAL/ PRAGMATIC GENDER (S6)

A. F1 (REWRITING) + F2 (STRUCTURE-PRESERVING PARAPHRASING)

S6 base paragraph: “The session began informally, with the facilitator smiling and saying, “Alright ladies and gentlemen, let’s get started.” When Sam questioned the timeline, the facilitator replied, “Easy there, no need to get emotional,” followed by a light laugh, as if to keep the mood relaxed. When Jordan started explaining a proposal, the facilitator interrupted mid-sentence, saying, “Let me help you phrase that more clearly,” and then added, “That’s actually a surprisingly thoughtful point.” As the discussion continued, comments delivered firmly were praised as “strong,” while more tentative remarks were described as “a bit soft.” Near the end, the facilitator said, “Let’s keep this moving, would you mind taking notes? You seem very organized,” and then turned to another participant with, “Why don’t you lead the next part? You sound confident,” treating both decisions as casual and helpful.